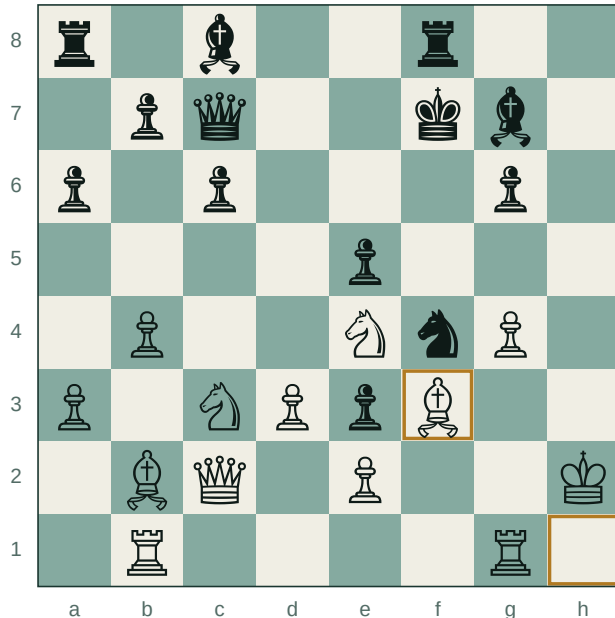


# Hook mating nets: Black, move 25

Hook mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Bf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**25...Rh8+ 26. Kg3 Rh3#**

**25...Rh8+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **26.Kg3**.

**26...Rh3#** Mate: rook on h3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on c2. Check for tactical protection.